
Enabling the Frontier

Structural Outline — All 32 Principles

Eric Forbes | Working Draft | June 8, 2026

Section I Building the Team (8 Principles)

- I.1. Cultivate Broad Capability First** — Build team depth before optimizing for output.
- I.2. Remove the Layers** — Eliminate every bureaucratic layer that slows frontier work.
- I.3. Altitude of Decomposition** — Use decomposition level as a framework for seniority and growth.
- I.4. Stakeholder Registry** — Design stakeholder communication as architecture, not a contact list.
- I.5. Project vs. Operations Clarity** — Know which mode you are in. They require different leadership.
- I.6. The Junkyard Principle** — *[Thesis to be developed with Eric.]*
- I.7. [Principle 7]** — *[Title and thesis to be confirmed.]*
- I.8. [Principle 8]** — *[Title and thesis to be confirmed.]*

Section II Leading the Team (9 Principles)

- II.1. Demo Discipline** — Demo what you have, on cadence. Always.
- II.2. Servant Leadership** — The leader's job is to serve the team's ability to do the work.
- II.3. Maintain Fundamentals Under Pressure** — Good habits erode first under stress. Defend them hardest then.
- II.4. The Power of Saying No** — Protecting team focus is a leadership act.
- II.5. Communication Infrastructure** — Design your information flows deliberately.
- II.6. Psychological Safety** — Teams that can fail safely learn faster.
- II.7. Humble Leadership** — *[Framing TBD—standalone or underpinning of servant leader-*

ship?]

II.8. Earn Your Real Estate — Internal promotion is a leadership responsibility, not an HR function.

II.9. Information Gatekeeping Is Toxicity — Hoarding information is invisible hierarchy. It destroys trust.

Section III Perspective & Framing (10 Principles)

III.1. Engineers as Self-Managing — When engineers understand the full trade space, they self-direct effectively.

III.2. Vision Sourcing vs. Vision Sinking — Leaders source vision upward. They do not sink it.

III.3. Radical Optimism — Optimism is a discipline, not a mood.

III.4. Protect the Passion — Guard what drives people. Passion is the engine of frontier work.

III.5. Program Management from Day One — Time, cost, scope, and manufacturability are dimensions from day one.

III.6. Feedback Is the Multiplier — The quantity of feedback loops is a primary driver of outcomes.

III.7. The Fulcrum Principle — Physical proximity to your team is a leadership act.

III.8. Super-Optimism: Protect the Magic — *[May merge with Radical Optimism—resolve with Eric.]*

III.9. [Principle 9] — *[Title and thesis to be confirmed.]*

III.10. [Principle 10] — *[Title and thesis to be confirmed.]*

Section IV Recognition & Belief (2 Principles) ! UNDERDEVELOPED

IV.1. Specific Earned Affirmation — Specific, earned affirmation is load-bearing fuel. Generic praise is noise.

IV.2. [Principle 2] — *[Title and thesis to be confirmed. Section needs development.]*

Section V Knowledge & Continuity (3 Principles)

- V.1. Apply Academic Research Rigor** — Research-grade documentation discipline is a competitive advantage.
- V.2. Stand on Each Other's Shoulders** — Each generation of the team should start from a higher floor than the last. (*One fully attached story: the Red Program Tracing story.*)
- V.3. [Principle 3]** — *[Title and thesis to be confirmed.]*

Story Bank — **Banked, not yet placed:** tracing/documentation story · too many architects · conflict via depersonalization · servant leader steps back · workflow design/pivot-persist · delegation without creative ownership · information gatekeeping

Open structural questions: (1) Helmier Catechism—formal or Eric's adaptation? (2) Apollo decomposition + time-as-currency—one principle or two? (3) Parenting analogy—standalone or emotional underpinning of servant leadership?